

8 Character Anatomy

Character Studio is a collection of tools that allows for sophisticated animation of characters in 3ds Max. Character Studio used to be an add-on package but is now included with 3ds Max. It has tools to create “smart” skeletons called Biped. These skeletons can be animated by using traditional key frame methods, but they also have the ability to accept motion capture data as well as generate their own walks and runs via footstep-based animation. These animations can be refined by using the traditional tools, but they also can be combined by using the Motion Mixer as well as Motion Flow. Character Studio also includes Physique, a character skinning tool, though any of the 3ds Max skinning tools can be used with Biped.



8.1 Biped

The heart of Character Studio is the Biped. A Biped is a standardised smart skeleton that has joint limits and other information built-in. The Biped can be created from the Systems tab of the Create panel or by choosing Create > Systems > Biped. Left-click and drag in a front viewport to create the Biped.

A basic Biped is a humanlike skeleton. Biped skeletons come in four flavours: Skeleton, Male, Female, and Classic. The Biped Create panel allows you to customize the skeleton as it is created. The number of joints in the spine, fingers, toes, and many other parts of